

Da Lat → Mui Ne → Saigon

8 - 12 September 2026

Haris Haikal & Aina Izzaty · Malaysia Airlines both ways · 2½ days Da Lat, 1 day Mui Ne
Every meal slot is a halal address. The cafés on your list are drinks-only stops.

The Five Days

DAY	DATE	WHERE	THE POINT OF THE DAY	OUTFIT
Day 1	Tue, 8 Sep	Fly in → Da Lat	Lake, L'angfarm, night market	Soft blue + brown
Day 2	Wed, 9 Sep	Da Lat — east	Cloud bridge at dawn, Cầu Đất, Lạc Hư, Miên Du Mực	Black leather am · cream
Day 3	Thu, 10 Sep	Da Lat → Mui Ne	Hydrangeas, Crazy House, coaster, then the pass	Soft pink + white
Day 4	Fri, 11 Sep	Mui Ne	White dunes at sunrise, Fairy Stream, beach	Blue + yellow
Day 5	Sat, 12 Sep	→ Saigon, fly home	Expressway, halal lunch, MAS	Khaki + black

Book Tonight, In This Order

- 1 Ask Malaysia Airlines to reroute the CGK ticket to Saigon**
MAS flies KUL-Saigon ~7 times a day (MH750 / MH758 / MH766). If they cancel Jakarta, ask to be moved to Saigon rather than refunded. **+60 3-7843-3000**
- 2 Flights: MAS KUL → SGN on 8 Sept, SGN → KUL on 12 Sept after 14:00; plus SGN → Da Lat on the 8th**
The domestic hop is 55 min, six a day, last at 17:30. Only the outbound needs a connection.
- 3 Hotels — 2 nights Da Lat, 2 nights Mui Ne**
Picks and booking links are on the hotels page. Central Da Lat and the Ham Tien strip in Mui Ne.
- 4 Cars: three bookings**
9 Sept **04.00 pickup** for the cloud bridge, all day east. 10 Sept Da Lat → Mui Ne on **QL28B**, pickup 13.15. 12 Sept Mui Ne → Saigon, pickup 07.00.
- 5 A jeep for the white dunes on the 11th**
05.00 start; the Mui Ne hotel arranges it. Agree the price up front.
- 6 Check hours: Cao Nguyên Hoa, Miên Du Mực, Haiyih, Cầu Gỗ**
All recent and their hours move. Hotel desk or their Facebook pages.
- 7 Cancel or move the Bandung bookings**
Holiday Inn Pasteur, Swiss-Belresort Dago, Fairfield CGK — ask for a waiver citing the airport closure. Message Kiki.
- 8 Insurance, eSIM, offline maps**
Re-issue for Vietnam; keep the Bandung paperwork for the claim.

Good To Know

Halal, honestly

Da Lat has two halal kitchens, both in the city. Nothing on the tourist routes is halal — plan meals around the city, treat cafés as drinks-only.

Money

Vietnamese dong. Cash for entry tickets (100–120k a head), dune jeeps and markets.

Visa

Visa-free for Malaysians, 30 days. Carry hotel bookings and onward tickets.

Getting around

Grab in Da Lat and Saigon; a booked car for the out-of-town days. Mui Ne is one strip.

Three climates

Da Lat 17–24°C, cold before dawn; Mui Ne 25–31°C; Saigon 30°C+ and humid.

Two early starts

04.15 on Day 2 and 05.00 on Day 4, both for light you cannot get later. Afternoons are deliberately empty.

MAS out: _____ SGN → DLI: _____ MAS home: _____ Da Lat hotel: _____
Mui Ne hotel: _____ Driver (Da Lat): _____ Driver (QL28B): _____ *Checked 6 Sept 2026.*

DAY 1

Fly in — the city evening

Tuesday, 8 September

START

Morning MAS from KLIA

FINISH

~22.00

SLEEP

Da Lat (nights 1-2)

Outfit: Soft blue + brown — café theme, and it's cool enough for layers

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
morning	KUL → SGN — Malaysia Airlines KLIA	~2h	MH750 / MH758 / MH766, about 7 a day. Take one landing in Saigon by early afternoon. Vietnam is 1 hour behind Malaysia .
~12.30	Connect at Tan Son Nhat Saigon — T2 international, T1 domestic	~3h	Separate tickets: collect bags, walk to T1, check in again.
~15.30	SGN → DLI — Vietnam Airlines or Vietjet Tan Son Nhat T1	55 min	Six a day, last departure 17:30.
Lien Khuong airport → Da Lat city — 30 km, ~40 min			
~17.30	Check in — central Da Lat By Xuan Huong Lake	45 min	See the hotels page.
~18.30	Xuan Huong Lake City centre Open in Google Maps	1h	The lake loop at dusk, lit and busy with locals. Walkable from any central hotel.
~19.45	Dinner — Fatimah Restaurant (halal) 18-24 Nguyễn Du, Ward 9	1.25h	Halal Vietnamese, and it has a prayer space. One of only two proper halal kitchens in Da Lat — worth building the evening around.
~21.00	L'angfarm Center City centre Open in Google Maps	45 min	Dried fruit, artichoke tea, jam, coffee, macadamia. Browse now, buy on the last morning.
~21.45	Da Lat Night Market Chợ Đêm, centre Open in Google Maps	45 min	Right beside L'angfarm. Drinks and fruit only — the grilled stalls are not halal.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- Da Lat is 1,500 m: 17-24°C and about 17°C tonight. Only cold evening of the trip — jacket tonight and at dawn tomorrow.
- Set the alarm for 03.45.** Tomorrow starts before four to reach the cloud bridge.
- Simpler alternative:** AirAsia flies KUL → Da Lat direct (AK571, 2h10) about 4 days a week. If 8 Sept is one, skip the Saigon connection.

DAY 2

East — the cloud bridge, Cầu Đất, the old town

Wednesday, 9 September

START
04.15FINISH
~20.30SLEEP
Da Lat (night 2)

Outfit: Black leather + white for the 04.15 start (it's genuinely cold) · change into **cream fairytale** at Euro Garden

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
04.15	Leave the hotel	—	The cloud bridge needs a 04.00–04.30 departure. Take the jacket, a torch and a flask.
~1 hour east via Trại Mát to Cầu Đất			
~05.15	Cầu Gỗ Săn Mây — the cloud-hunting wooden bridge Cầu Đất tea hills, ~27 km east Open in Google Maps	1.5h	The wooden walkway out over the tea slopes with cloud sitting in the valley below. Past Cầu Đất Farm, turn toward the lavender field, then three minutes on.
~07.00	Haiyih Coffee — Cầu Đất Cầu Đất Open in Google Maps	1h	A cloud-hunting café on the same hill. Drinks only — bring the breakfast you packed, or wait for lunch.
~08.30	Euro Garden Cầu Đất QL20, Cầu Đất — 25 km Open in Google Maps	2.5h	7.2 ha at 1,650 m: flower fields, a miniature French castle, an Eiffel Tower, a railway café. Change into the cream outfit here. The tea terraces around it are free to walk.
~25 min back toward Xuân Trường			
~11.30	Lạc Hư Cổ Trấn Lâm Văn Thạnh rd, Xuân Trường Open in Google Maps	2h	Stone houses, tiled roofs and a lake, done as a Chinese ancient town. ~120,000 VND with a drink; open 05:00–20:00.
~13.45	Miền Du Mục Lâm Văn Thạnh rd — same road Open in Google Maps	2h	Canvas tents on grass over pine hills, the nomad-camp café. Built for sitting still. Drinks only.
~20 min west to Trại Mát			
~16.15	Thác Mây & Chill Đốc số 9, Trại Mát Open in Google Maps	1.5h	Cloud and ravine views from the other side of the day — it runs 05:00 to 19:00, so sunset works as well as sunrise.
~18.30	Dinner — Halal Food Da Lat 70 Hoàng Văn Thụ, Ward 5	1.25h	Closes 20:30 — be there by 19:00 at the latest. Around \$5–10 a head.
~20.00	Reply 1994 (optional) Alley 31 Sao Nam, Ward 11 Open in Google Maps	1h	Retro café-homestay, open until 22:00. Only if you're not finished by dinner.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- **Food today needs planning.** There is nothing halal out at Cầu Đất — take breakfast and snacks from the city, and treat every café as drinks-only.
- The whole day is one road east, so nothing doubles back. Book the car the night before with an 04.00 pickup.
- Cầu Đất is 1,650 m and cold before sunrise; by noon you'll be in a t-shirt.

DAY 3

Hydrangeas, the coaster, then the pass to the sea

Thursday, 10 September

START
07.30FINISH
~21.00SLEEP
Move → Mui Ne (nights 3–4)**Outfit: Soft pink + white** — the hydrangea fields are the backdrop

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
07.30	Suối Bình Yên + Hydrangea Street Hoa Cẩm Tú Cầu st, Ward 3 — 10–15 min out Open in Google Maps	1.5h	A stream-side garden café on Hydrangea Street — the cẩm tú cầu fields are right there, and they flower May to December. Coffee only; breakfast is at the next stop.
~09.15	Breakfast — Halal Food Da Lat 70 Hoàng Văn Thụ, Ward 5 (opens 07:30)	45 min	Eat properly now — the road south has nothing halal on it.
~10.15	Crazy House Huỳnh Thúc Kháng, city Open in Google Maps	1h	The tree-and-cave house. Narrow stairs, so it jams up later in the morning.
~15 min south on QL20			
~11.30	Datanla — new alpine coaster QL20, ~5 km south Open in Google Maps	1.25h	The rebuilt coaster down through the forest, falls at the bottom. It's on the road out of town, so no detour.
~12.50	Collect the bags + a packed lunch Da Lat	40 min	Ask the hotel for a packed lunch, or buy fruit and bread. Eat it at the pass.
DRIVE: Da Lat → Mui Ne on QL28B over the Đại Ninh pass — 155 km, 3.5–4 hours			
~17.15	Drop bags — Ham Tien beach strip Mui Ne	20 min	Straight in, bags down, back out — you're chasing the light.
~17.45	Red Sand Dunes (Đồi Hồng) for sunset ~10 min from the strip Open in Google Maps	1.25h	Orange dunes right by the road, at their best in the last hour of light.
~19.30	Dinner — Mughal House Indian Halal 246/2B Nguyễn Đình Chiểu, Mui Ne	1.5h	Halal Indian on the main strip, and the easiest reliable dinner in Mui Ne.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- **Leave Da Lat by 13.30 at the latest** — QL28B comes down the Đại Ninh pass and you want it in daylight.
- If the morning slips, drop Crazy House. Datanla is on the road out; Crazy House is a detour back into town.
- You go from 17°C at breakfast to 31°C at dinner. Jacket to the bottom of the bag after this morning.

DAY 4

Mui Ne — white dunes at sunrise, red canyon after

Friday, 11 September

START
05.00FINISH
~21.00SLEEP
Mui Ne (night 4)
Outfit: Blue + yellow — sand, sky and sea all day

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
05.00	White Sand Dunes (Bàu Trắng) — sunrise ~35 km northeast, ~45 min Open in Google Maps	2.5h	The pale dunes, the only real desert in Vietnam. Sunrise is cool and empty and the light is the entire point. Jeeps and quads wait at the gate — agree the price and whether it's per person or per vehicle before getting in.
~07.45	Bàu Trắng lotus lake Beside the dunes Open in Google Maps	45 min	Freshwater lake right against the sand, fringed with lotus. Water, lotus and desert in one frame.
~45 min back to Mui Ne			
~09.30	Breakfast at the hotel Ham Tien	1h	Hotel breakfast is the safe halal-friendly option — ask for eggs, bread, fruit and skip the cold cuts.
~10.45	Fairy Stream (Suối Tiên) Ham Tien, off the main road Open in Google Maps	1.25h	Wade barefoot up a warm ankle-deep stream between red and white sandstone. Ten minutes in it opens into a small canyon. Leave shoes at the entrance.
~12.15	Lunch — Mughal House or T'HALAL Mui Ne strip / 63A Huỳnh Thúc Kháng, Phan Thiết	1.25h	T'HALAL does Vietnamese halal and seafood in Phan Thiết town, ~20 min down the coast — worth it if you want something other than Indian.
~13.45	Beach and pool — the hot hours Your resort	2.5h	This is what Mui Ne is for. Do nothing until four.
~16.15	Fishing village + Ông Địa rock beach Mui Ne village end Open in Google Maps	1.5h	Round blue coracle boats pulled up on the sand — the most photographed thing here after the dunes. Best when the fleet is in.
~18.00	Sunset + kite surfers Ham Tien strip	1h	Mui Ne is Vietnam's kite-surfing capital and the wind gets up late.
~19.30	Dinner — halal, then pack Mui Ne	1.5h	

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- Second 5am in three days, then an empty afternoon. The dunes are only good at the ends of the day, so that's the trade.
- Sun is far stronger than Da Lat — hat, sunscreen, water. Sand gets everywhere; leave the good camera bag in the room.
- **Book the car for tomorrow tonight** — a 07.00 pickup for Saigon.

DAY 5

Down the expressway, fly home from Saigon

Saturday, 12 September

START
07.00

FINISH
KUL

SLEEP
—

Outfit: Khaki + black — travel day

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
07.00	Checkout, straight onto the road Mui Ne	—	Breakfast boxed from the hotel — you want to be moving early.
DRIVE: Mui Ne → Saigon on the Dầu Giây-Phan Thiết expressway — 200-220 km, 2.5-3 hours			
~10.15	Arrive Saigon District 1	—	Tan Son Nhat is inside the city, so you're already almost at the airport.
~10.45	Early lunch — halal, District 1 Around Bến Thành	1h	Saigon has plenty of halal, unlike everywhere else on this trip: the Muslim quarter around Đông Du street by Bến Thành has several. Last proper meal before the flight.
~12.15	Check-in + immigration Tan Son Nhat T2 Open in Google Maps	2h buffer	Saigon traffic is the variable, not the airport.
afternoon	SGN → KUL — Malaysia Airlines Tan Son Nhat T2	~2h	Book a departure after 14:00 so the morning drive has slack. Malaysia is 1 hour ahead.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- **Saigon is the nearest useful airport to Mui Ne** — 2.5-3h on the expressway, against ~4h north to Cam Ranh. It also has 7 MAS flights a day to KUL against Cam Ranh's ~4 a week on AirAsia.
- If the drive worries you, move to Saigon the night before and swap the Mui Ne beach afternoon for a Saigon evening.

Halal food — the whole list

Da Lat has two halal kitchens. Everything else on your list is a drinks-only stop.

PLACE	WHERE	WHAT TO KNOW
Fatimah Restaurant Open in Google Maps	18-24 Nguyễn Du, Ward 9, Da Lat	Halal Vietnamese, with a prayer space. The better of the two for a sit-down dinner. Day 1 dinner is built around it.
Halal Food Da Lat Open in Google Maps	70 Hoàng Văn Thụ, Ward 5, Da Lat	Open 07:30-20:30 , about \$5-10 a head. Doubles as breakfast on Day 3. Note the early close — don't plan a late dinner here.
Vegetarian (chay) restaurants Open in Google Maps	Da Lat city — several	The practical fallback on days you're back late: Thiền Duyên, Tu Hạnh, Thanh Tịnh, Hoa Sen. No meat at all, so no doubt about the meat.
Mughal House Indian Halal Open in Google Maps	246/2B Nguyễn Đình Chiểu, Mui Ne	Halal Indian on the Ham Tien strip. The reliable dinner in Mui Ne, and the closest to most resorts.
T'HALAL Restaurant Open in Google Maps	63A Huỳnh Thúc Kháng, Phan Thiết	Vietnamese halal and seafood , ~20 min down the coast in Phan Thiết town. Worth the trip for a change from Indian. 100-300k VND.
Halal Indian + seafood Open in Google Maps	109B Nguyễn Đình Chiểu, Phan Thiết	Second Phan Thiết option, same price bracket. Phone ahead: +84 934 790 556.
Đông Du street area Open in Google Maps	District 1, Saigon, by Bến Thành	Saigon's Muslim quarter — several halal restaurants and a mosque. This is the Day 5 lunch stop, and the easiest halal eating of the whole trip.
Your hotel breakfast Open in Google Maps	Da Lat and Mui Ne	Ask for eggs, bread, fruit, noodles without the pork broth. The simplest safe meal of each day, and it's already paid for.

HOW TO EAT WELL ON THIS TRIP

- **None of the cafés on your list are halal kitchens** — Thác Mây, Haiyih, Miên Du Mộc, Lạc Hư Cổ Trấn, Reply 1994, Suối Bình Yên and the rest. Coffee, tea and packaged drinks are fine; treat their food menus as off the list.
- Day 2 is the hard one: you're out east from 04.15 with no halal food anywhere near Cầu Đất. **Take breakfast and snacks from the city** and keep dinner at Halal Food Da Lat before it closes at 20:30.
- Night market: fruit, roasted chestnuts, corn and hot soy milk are fine. The grilled-meat stalls are not.

Where to stay, and why

One central Da Lat base covers every cluster; one Ham Tien resort covers Mui Ne

HOTEL	ROUGH PRICE	WHY THIS ONE, AND HOW TO BOOK
DA LAT — stay by Xuan Huong Lake	—	Every cluster on your list radiates out from the centre: Cầu Đất east, Tà Nung west, Lạc Dương north, Datanla south. A lakeside hotel is equidistant from all of them, and puts the lake, the night market, L'angfarm and both halal restaurants within walking distance. Browse them all: booking.com — hotels near Xuan Huong Lake
Dalat Palace Heritage Hotel	\$\$\$	The 1922 colonial grande dame on the hill above the lake, 5 minutes' walk to the night market. The most photogenic base in the city, and the cream-outfit day starts at your own front door. Find it & book
Golden Sun Hotel Dalat	\$\$	Three minutes' walk from the lake, parking on site, straightforward and central. The efficient middle option. Find it & book
Peach Valley Hotel Dalat	\$	Ten minutes from the lake, terrace, own parking — the value pick if you'd rather spend on the drivers. Find it & book
MUI NE — stay on the Ham Tien strip	—	Everything in Mui Ne is on one road: Fairy Stream, the fishing village and Mughal House are all minutes away, and the dune jeeps collect from the hotel. Browse the strip: booking.com — all Mui Ne hotels
Anantara Mui Ne Resort	\$\$\$	The established high-end choice on Ham Tien, beachfront with big pools. Worth it when the plan is a deliberately empty afternoon. Find it & book
Ham Tien beachfront, 4-star	\$\$	The strip is full of good four-stars with private beach and two pools. Filter for beachfront and 8.0+ and take whatever is cheapest for your dates — they are much of a muchness. Browse the strip

BOOKING NOTES

- Prices move a lot with the date; I have not checked live rates, so treat \$ / \$\$ / \$\$\$ as relative only.
- In Da Lat, ask for a room away from the street — the centre is noisy until late and you are getting up at 03.45.
- In Mui Ne, ask the resort to arrange the dune jeep and the Saigon car when you check in. It is cheaper than booking either from Malaysia.
- No hotel on this trip is halal-certified. Breakfast is easy to navigate; dinner comes from the food page.

What didn't fit, and what to swap

Your list runs to about 28 places; 2½ days holds roughly a third of them

PLACE	WHERE	WHY, AND WHEN TO SLOT IT IN
Mongo Land + Floating Town + Cao Nguyễn Hoa + Dream Garden Open in Google Maps	Tà Nung, 15–17 km west	The whole western cluster falls out. Yurts and archery, wooden houses on an emerald lake, the flower-highland park and a forest café — all on one road, a full day for the four. This is what a third Da Lat day should buy.
Pink Valley + Langbiang Open in Google Maps	Lạc Dương, 12–22 km north	Rose valley and the mountain, ten minutes apart. They sit on the road to Nha Trang — the wrong direction for Mui Ne, which is why they drop.
Happy Hill + Clay Tunnel + The Wilder Nest Open in Google Maps	Tuyền Lâm, 6–12 km south	All three are minutes from Datanla, so they are the easiest swap-in on Day 3 if you skip Crazy House and leave for Mui Ne at 14.00 instead of 13.15.
Rừng Thông Mơ Farm & Bistro Open in Google Maps	Hoa Hồng st — 30–45 min out	Pine-forest farm and bistro. Confirm the direction locally before committing an afternoon to it.
Rừng Mơ Cafe, The Forest, Auro Garden, Giấc Mơ Đà Lạt Open in Google Maps	unconfirmed	I could not pin these down from here — several new Da Lat cafés share near-identical names. Auro Garden may be Euro Garden (already on Day 2), and Giấc Mơ may be Dream Garden in Tà Nung. Check with the hotel.
Cầu Gỗ Open in Google Maps	Cầu Đất	Already on Day 2 — this is the same wooden cloud bridge as 'Cầu Đất Cloud Hunting Wooden Bridge' on your list.
Kê Gà lighthouse + dragon fruit farms Open in Google Maps	~60 km southwest of Mui Ne	If you want a second Mui Ne outing: an 1890s lighthouse reached by boat, through miles of dragon-fruit trellises lit at night.
A third Da Lat day Open in Google Maps	—	Would cost the Mui Ne night. If flowers matter more than dunes, drop Mui Ne, keep three full Da Lat days and fly home from Da Lat via Saigon.

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE

- Nothing here is missing by accident — it is what 2½ days costs against a 28-place list.
- **If you add one Da Lat day, spend it west:** Mongo Land, Floating Town, Cao Nguyễn Hoa and Dream Garden are all on the Tà Nung road.
- If a stop disappoints or closes, pull the nearest swap from this page rather than driving somewhere new.